Uber Find My Ride

ASSIGNMENT DETAILS

ASSIGNMENT TITLE

Uber Find My Ride Assignment

NAME

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DATE

19 June 2026

Introduction

BACKGROUND & RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

01 — BACKGROUND

Uber is one of India's most widely used mobility platforms, operating across **Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, and Pune** — cities defined by dense infrastructure, regulated transit zones, and complex pickup environments. While the platform reliably connects riders and drivers, a persistent gap exists at the very start of every trip: **the pickup selection stage**. Users drop a pin wherever they are standing, the app accepts it without validation, and drivers navigate to a point that may be inside a **restricted zone, a narrow lane, or a gated complex**. The confusion that follows — calls, waiting, cancellations — plays out only after the driver has already arrived.

02 — RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

This study was conducted to evaluate the pickup experience problem before proposing any solution. The core objectives were:

01 Conduct **market research and competitive analysis** to understand demand across user segments, size the target market, study existing alternatives, assess regulatory restrictions, and identify relevant market trends

02 Analyse the **pickup pain point in depth** — identifying exactly where in the user and driver flow friction originates, which locations trigger it most, and how frequently it results in cancellations or delays

03 Conduct **in-depth user interviews** with riders to gather qualitative insights on behaviour, workarounds, and frustrations at the pickup stage

04 Synthesise findings into **strategy implications and research-led product ideas** that are grounded in real user pain and validated by market and regulatory context

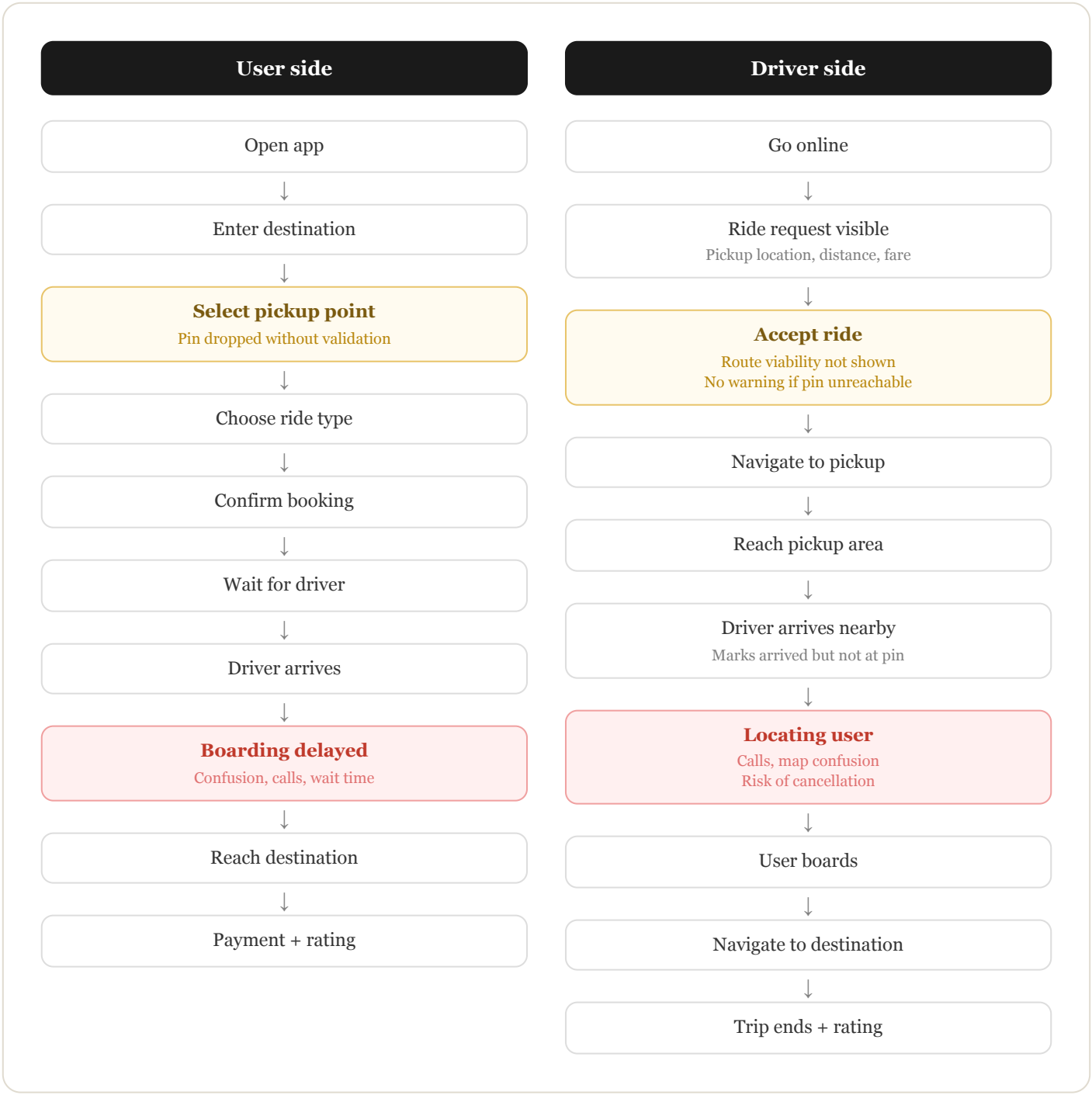
03 — SCOPE

This research focuses on **cab rides in metro cities**, with a primary lens on **Premium and Corporate users** booking from airports, malls, metro stations, and large office complexes — the segment where pickup confusion is most acute and the cost of failure is highest.

PAIN POINT ANALYSIS

Uber Pickup: The Unreachable Pin Problem

When a user drops a pin, the app accepts it without validating whether a car can actually reach it — creating confusion that plays out only after the driver arrives.



Issue — where the problem originates Impact — where it plays out

ROOT CAUSE

Uber's pickup experience is **passive**. The app accepts any pin without checking road topology — restricted zones, gated complexes, one-way streets, narrow lanes. Drivers only discover the problem on arrival. The fallout — calls, waiting, cancellations — hits at the worst moment: **after the driver is already there.**

REGULATORY ANALYSIS · INDIA · JUNE 2026

Regulatory environment — pickup restrictions by locale

Rules and laws affecting cab pickups at airports, metro stations, and malls

KEY INSIGHT FOR UBER

Pickup pin dropped by user often lands in a zone where cars are legally prohibited from entering.

01 — Airports

DELHI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LTD (NEWDELHIAIRPORT.IN)

FOUNDATIONAL AREA RULE

T1 and T2 passengers must board from designated arrivals zones only. T3 pickups are restricted to a remote cab marshalling area — not the terminal forecourt.

PM IMPLICATION

A user pinning their location at the terminal door is dropping a pin in a restricted zone. Uber accepts the pin silently, dispatches a driver who cannot legally enter, and the pickup fails.

02 — Metro stations

DMRC · MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL · BMRCL · HMRL

FOUNDATIONAL AREA RULE

Metro rail authorities across Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, and Hyderabad have designated cab pickup bays set back from exit gates. Roadside stopping is prohibited within 50–100 m of station exits.

PM IMPLICATION

Users exiting a metro gate often pin their live GPS location — which may be in a restricted roadside zone. Drivers circle, accrue wait charges, or cancel.

03 — Malls

THE HINDU · USER-REPORTED EXPERIENCE

FOUNDATIONAL AREA RULE

- Cabs banned from main gate — passengers must walk to ground-floor parking or MLCP cab stand.
- PIN-based boarding in use — driver cannot confirm pickup until passenger is physically at the car.
- Strict wait time 3–10 min — drivers may be fined or removed after violations.
- Peak hour entry restrictions — traffic marshals limit commercial vehicles during weekends and sales.

PM IMPLICATION

Wait time limits mean the driver cancels if the user takes more than 5 min to reach the cab — a direct product problem with no in-app guidance to prevent it.

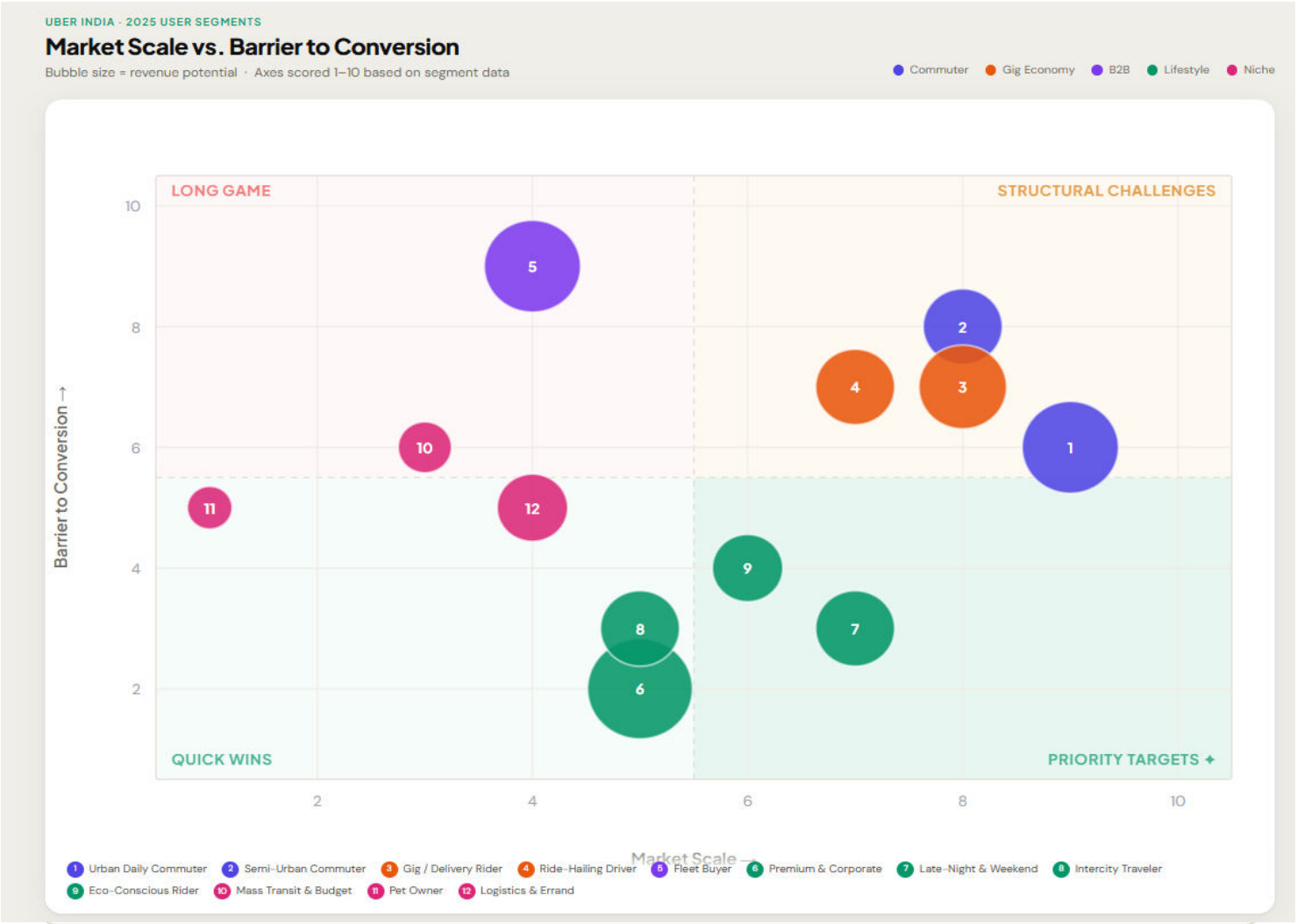
CONCLUSION

Pickup confusion is not a UX problem — it is a regulatory compliance gap.

Uber's pin-drop system creates a systematic mismatch between where users want to be picked up and where drivers can legally stop. Resolving this requires geofenced restricted zone detection, in-app guidance to verified pickup points, and surface-specific user flows — not just clearer copy.

Sources: DIAL · DMRC · Maharashtra Metro Rail · BMRCL · HMRL · The Hindu

June 2026



STRATEGIC ANALYSIS

Priority target: Premium & Corporate

Segment 6 sits in the Priority Targets quadrant — high market scale, lowest barrier to conversion, and highest revenue potential across all 12 segments.

UBER BLACK · LIFESTYLE

Premium & Corporate

5/10	2/10	9/10
MARKET SCALE	BARRIER	REV. POTENTIAL

Business travelers · Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bangalore

- 34M+ km on Uber Black in 2025
- Airport + executive travel are top use cases
- Price-insensitive — reliability matters most

> BARRIER
> High expectations for vehicle quality and reliability — pickup confusion directly erodes trust

WHY THIS SEGMENT

Highest ROI, least resistance

- Lowest barrier to conversion of all 12 segments
- Already paying premium — expectations are high
- Pickup confusion is their top pain point
- Fixing this = direct revenue protection
- Concentrated in 3 cities — easier to pilot

PM CONCLUSION

Segment 6 is the **right place to start.** Low friction to adopt, high willingness to pay, and a problem we can solve with existing tech today.

MARKET ANALYSIS · INDIA · JUNE 2026

Market trends — why this problem is urgent to solve now

Four trends that make the pickup confusion problem bigger every year

WHY URGENCY MATTERS

The market is growing fast, the problem segment is scaling, the tech is ready, and users expect more. Waiting to solve this means millions more broken pickup experiences every quarter.

TREND 01 —

Ride hailing in India is growing at extraordinary scale

MARKSMEN DAILY / UBER INDIA 2025 REPORT

11.6B km
COVERED IN 2025

+26.5%
INCREASE OVER 2024

Uber trips in India covered 11.6 billion km in 2025 — a 26.5% increase over 2024. That is 8,840 trips from Srinagar to Kanyakumari every single day. As volume grows, even a small percentage of rides facing pickup confusion translates into millions of broken experiences annually.

TREND 02 —

Premium and airport rides are the fastest growing segment

UBER INDIA 2025 REPORT

34M km
UBER BLACK IN 2025

365M km
EVS COVERED

Uber Black clocked 34 million km in 2025 with airport and work travel as the top use cases. EVs covered 365 million km. Both segments are growing in cities with the most complex pickup locations — Delhi NCR, Mumbai, and Bangalore — making the pickup problem more acute, not less.

TREND 03 —

Geofencing and location tech is now mature and affordable

INDUSTRY OBSERVATION

3 yrs
AGO THIS WAS HARD

Today
IT IS BUILDABLE

Geofencing technology — which allows apps to define precise pickup zones and validate a user's pin against them — is now widely available and cost-effective. Google Maps already supports indoor navigation in select Indian airports. What was technically hard 3 years ago is buildable today.

TREND 04 —

User expectations from apps have risen sharply

INDUSTRY OBSERVATION

Swiggy
REAL-TIME UPDATES

Zomato
LIVE TRACKING

Swiggy shows real-time delivery updates. Zomato tracks the delivery person live on a map. IRCTC sends platform and coach notifications before you board. Users now expect apps to guide them proactively — not just show information. Uber's passive pickup experience feels dated by comparison.

WHY NOW?

Four forces converging — volume, premium growth, available tech, and rising expectations.

Each trend independently justifies fixing pickup confusion. Together they make the cost of inaction compounding.
The problem will not self-correct as Uber scales — it will magnify.

Sources: Uber India 2025 Annual Report (via Marksmen Daily) · Google Maps Indoor Navigation · Industry observation

Uber Pickup Experience Research Survey (India)

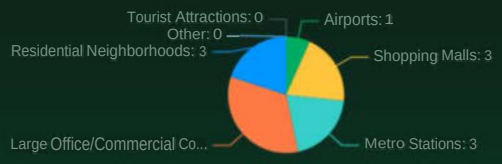
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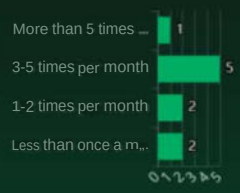
Dashboard Responses

10

1. What types of locations do you most frequently book an Uber pickup from?



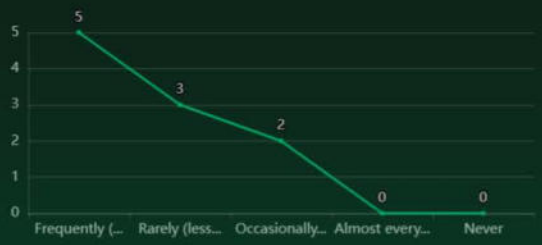
2. How often do you book an Uber pickup from complex locations like airports, malls,



3. Have you ever experienced an issue where your driver could not locate you at the



4. How often do you experience a mismatch between the pinned pickup location you selected and where your driver actually stops?



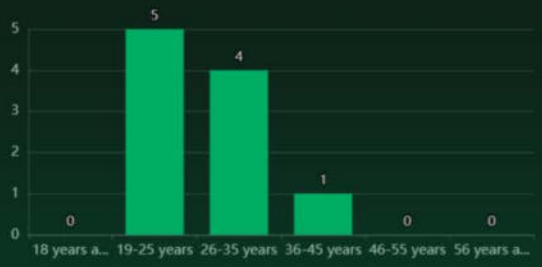
5. Have you or your driver ever cancelled a trip due to pickup location confusion?



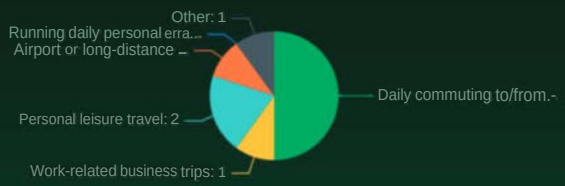
8. How do you currently select your pickup point on the Uber app when you are at a busy.



6. What is your age group?



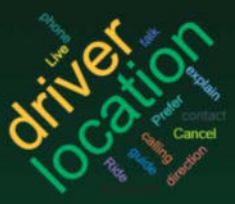
7. What is the main purpose of your most frequent Uber rides?



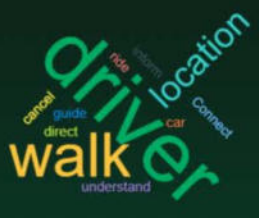
13. What changes do you wish Uber would make to the pickup stage to improve the experience for users at complex locations?



9. When your driver cannot find you at the planned pickup point, what steps do you



10. When there is a mismatch between the pickup pin you dropped and where your driver



11. If you have ever cancelled a trip or had a trip cancelled due to pickup confusion, can you



12. What workarounds, tips or tricks have you developed over time to avoid pickup location



USER RESEARCH · QUALITATIVE INTERVIEWS · JUNE 2026

User Interview Insights

Key findings derived from qualitative user interviews conducted to understand pickup-related challenges in Uber's rider experience.

INTERVIEW → INSIGHT → EVIDENCE → OPPORTUNITY

N = 3 INTERVIEWS · IN-DEPTH · 45–60 MIN EACH

INTERVIEW 01 — USER SEGMENT

Daily Office Commuter

QUALITATIVE

PROFILE

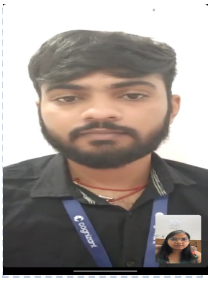
Uses Uber 4–5× per week, primarily from metro stations and office parks in Delhi NCR

KEY INSIGHT — VERBATIM

> "I always pin the gate I exit from, but the driver ends up at some other entrance and then calls me asking where I am. I end up walking 400 metres in the heat."

PRODUCT OPPORTUNITY

Real-time pin validation against known restricted zones at metro stations, with a suggested correction before the driver is dispatched.



INTERVIEW 02 — USER SEGMENT

Frequent Airport Traveler

QUALITATIVE

PROFILE

Flies 2–3× per month, books Uber Black and Premier from IGI, BLR, and BOM airports

KEY INSIGHT — VERBATIM

> "I've missed two flights because the driver circled the terminal for fifteen minutes. He couldn't enter the zone my pin was in. Nobody told either of us that."

PRODUCT OPPORTUNITY

Surface pre-validated terminal pickup zones during the booking step — before the rider confirms the ride — with gate-specific instructions per terminal.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Consent not given by the interviewee.

INTERVIEW 03 — USER SEGMENT

Mall Visitor

QUALITATIVE

PROFILE

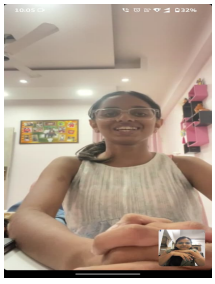
Weekend shopper, uses Uber from major malls in Mumbai and Bengaluru 2–3× per month

KEY INSIGHT — VERBATIM

> "The driver cancelled on me twice at Phoenix Mills. I was standing right outside the main entrance — apparently cabs aren't allowed there. I had no idea."

PRODUCT OPPORTUNITY

Display an in-app warning when a rider pins a mall entrance where commercial vehicles are restricted, with a walking route to the nearest valid pickup bay.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Four synthesized findings across all interviews.

01 Users struggle to identify the correct pickup location in crowded or regulated environments. — HIGH SIGNAL

02 Driver-rider coordination frequently devolves into phone calls and messages after dispatch — a signal that the app failed at the booking step - Supported by Survey Data. — HIGH SIGNAL

03 Designated pickup zones exist operationally but are invisible to riders inside the Uber app at the moment they matter most. — MEDIUM SIGNAL

04 Pickup confusion is a direct driver of cancellations, not just frustration — the cost is quantifiable. — MEDIUM SIGNAL

PROPOSED SOLUTION · PRODUCT DESIGN · JUNE 2026

Smart Pickup Validation & Guidance System

Based on insights gathered from user research, market analysis, and regulatory research, Uber can introduce a Smart Pickup Validation & Guidance System to improve pickup reliability in complex locations.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

Replace passive pin-drop with an active, validated pickup guidance layer — for both riders and drivers — anchored to real regulatory zones.

Rider Side Experience

5 FEATURES

01 Predefined Pickup Points

Provide validated pickup options for airports, malls, metro stations, office complexes, and other high-traffic locations instead of relying solely on user-pinned locations.

02 Traffic-Aware Pickup Recommendations

Recommend the most efficient pickup point based on real-time traffic conditions and suggest better alternatives when congestion is detected.

03 Smart User Nudges

If a rider selects a custom pickup location, display a contextual warning when the location is likely to cause delays, accessibility issues, or pickup confusion.

04 Walking Distance & Step Count Visibility

Display walking distance and estimated steps required to reach a recommended pickup point, helping users make informed decisions while encouraging short, convenient walks.

05 Verified Pickup Zone Mapping

Surface designated pickup zones that are already approved and operationally feasible at airports, metro stations, malls, and other regulated locations.

Driver Side Experience

4 FEATURES

01 Accessibility-Based Pickup Validation

Ensure recommended pickup points are accessible to drivers by validating road restrictions, one-way routes, entry barriers, and vehicle access limitations.

02 Validated Pickup Navigation

Guide drivers directly to approved pickup locations, reducing unnecessary detours and confusion.

03 Shared Pickup Context

Ensure both riders and drivers view the same validated pickup point, creating a single source of truth and reducing coordination calls.

04 Driver Traffic Optimization

Recommend alternate pickup points when traffic or temporary restrictions make the selected location difficult to access.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Six measurable outcomes from system adoption.

- Reduced pickup location mismatches
- Fewer rider-driver coordination calls
- Lower cancellation rates
- Faster pickup completion times
- Improved reliability in complex urban locations
- Better rider and driver experience

Conclusion

RESEARCH SYNTHESIS & RECOMMENDATION

01 — RESEARCH FINDINGS

Through **market research, regulatory analysis, user surveys, and interviews**, this study identified **pickup location mismatch** as a recurring friction point in the Uber rider journey. Findings revealed that users frequently face **delays, coordination calls, and cancellations**, particularly in complex locations such as **airports, metro stations, malls, and office complexes**. The research also highlighted that existing **infrastructure and regulations** often conflict with user-pinned pickup locations, creating inefficiencies for both **riders and drivers**.

02 — PROPOSED SOLUTION

To address these challenges, the proposed **Smart Pickup Validation & Guidance System** leverages **validated pickup zones, accessibility checks, traffic-aware recommendations, and aligned rider-driver guidance**. By reducing ambiguity and improving **pickup reliability**, the solution has the potential to **lower cancellations, decrease coordination efforts, and enhance the overall user experience**.

03 — STRATEGIC OPPORTUNITY

Ultimately, solving pickup friction represents an opportunity for Uber to improve **operational efficiency** while building greater **trust among riders and drivers**.